

The bright stripes on a lionfish warn other creatures off: the venom in its fins can be deadly.

Twinspot wrasse

Lionfish

The con artist

The twinspot wrasse tries to fool its enemies. There are two big spots on its body that look like eyes. It buries itself in the sand and just shows the spots, making it look like a large, frightening fish.

Friend or foe?

These clownfish use venomous sea anemones for protection; the venom doesn't seem to affect the fish, who dive in when danger approaches.

Venom

The bright colouring of some venomous fish tells the predators that they would not make a tasty meal. This spiky lionfish is one of the most venomous fish in the sea.

Clownfish

Turn and learn

Insect defence:
pp. 114-115

Hidey holes

Garden eels dig holes in the sand. During the day they hang out looking like a field of sea grass catching small fish. When threatened they dive back into their holes.